Defining Your Data

In Depot, we defined a number of models, including one for an `Order`. This particular model has a number of attributes, such as an `email` address of type String. In addition to the attributes that we defined, Rails provided an attribute named `id` that contains the primary key for the record. Rails also provides several additional attributes, including attributes that track when each row was last updated. Finally, Rails supports relationships between models, such as the relationship between orders and line items.

When you think about it, Rails provides a lot of support for models. Let's examine each in turn.

Organizing Using Tables and Columns

Each subclass of `ApplicationRecord`, such as our `Order` class, wraps a separate database table. By default, Active Record assumes that the name of the table associated with a given class is the plural form of the name of that class. If the class name contains multiple capitalized words, the table name is assumed to have underscores between these words, as shown in the table.

Classname	Table Name
Order	orders
TaxAgency	tax_agencies
Batch	batches
Diagnosis	diagnoses
LineItem	line_items
Person	people
Datum	data
Quantity	quantities

These rules reflect Rails' philosophy that class names should be singular while the names of tables should be plural.